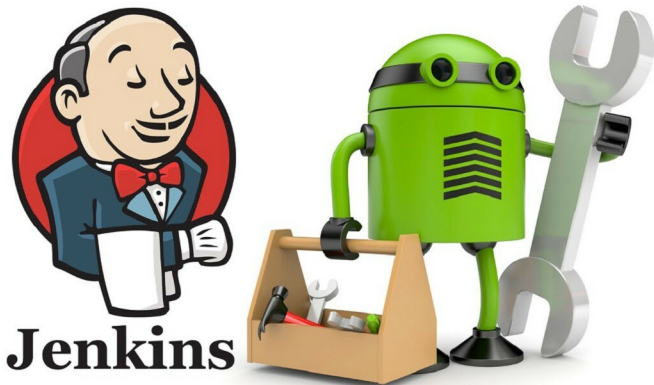


Use Jenkins as an Android App Development Framework

This is a continuation of our article 'Getting Started with Jenkins'. Jenkins plays an important role in Android app development since it has an Android Emulator plugin. Read on to find out more.



In the last article, carried in the October 2013 issue of *Open Source For You*, I gave readers a brief introduction to Jenkins and how to get started with it. Now, let's explore some very useful and innovative Jenkins plugins and features, while learning how to use them.

As discussed earlier, Jenkins is not only about building a project periodically and sending updates about the status, but has greater capabilities! For example, with Jenkins plugins, you can use Jenkins as an Android app development framework or a monitoring tool for cron jobs run in Linux, or use it for file tracking, and so on. Jenkins currently has hundreds of such plugins available. Let's look at some of these plugins and how to configure Jenkins.

The Android emulator plugin

This is one of the most innovative and, of course, useful features of Jenkins. With the plugin installed, Jenkins allows you to build and run an Android Apk file on an Android virtual machine.

So, tasks like SDK installation, build file generation, emulator creation and launching, Apk installation/ uninstallation, monkey testing and analysis -- all can be done automatically once Jenkins is configured. Let's look at how to install this plugin and then configure Jenkins for Android app development.

To install the plugin, click on the *Manage Jenkins* link on the left side of the page and then click the *Manage plugins* link. In the page that appears, click on the tab called *Available* and scroll down to find the *Android Emulator* plugin. Just click on the check box and then press either one of the buttons to install the plugin. As you click the button, Jenkins automatically prepares and downloads the plugin along with any other plugins that are required.

After installation, you can check and change the settings for the plugin in the main configuration page, that is *Manage Jenkins* → *Configure System*. You find a new field here for *Android*, once the plugin is installed.

Once installed, you can start using the plugin in a way